honey "don't kick over the beehive". She believes that criticism will put people on the defensive; criticism will force people to justify themselves. This could be dangerous; it may wound their pride, hurt their sense of importance –and is sure to arouse resentment.

Flattery is insincere and selfish. Appreciation is sincere and comes from the heart.

She believes everybody wants attention and admiration. The only way to get the best of an argument is to avoid the argument. She prefers asking questions rather than giving direct orders.

This is her mantra and belief that this is a new way of life and management. "Experiment in silence", she says, quoting Dale Carnegie.

Though Chairman K.K Modi had passed away in November 2019, he had entrusted her the baton of steering the company after him. For Dr. Bina Modi it was a challenge and a 'new normal'. The onset of the pandemic also brought its own set of challenges. All this called for a very strong, mature personality to steady the legacy, family and group companies to the next level and "take home" the ship to safe shores. Dr. Bina Modi, who has acquired great values and culture from her late husband, took on the challenge and with a firm hand started her journey of the new normal. Her guiding mantra in this endeavor was 'Integrity, Simplicity, Humility' and 'Focussed Drive'.

The first challenge was being accepted as Managing Trustee of the Trust and Managing Director of Modi Enterprises. Taking on the mantle as a matriarch, wasn't easy for someone who had always stayed in the shadows of the legendary K K Modi. She had to break the proverbial glass ceiling and prove her mettle. She had to balance the family and build trust all around. The Trust deed written by K K Modi had to be executed and made simple and clear. This was a great opportunity to show her emotional quotient and people skills. The old guard had to be transitioned and a new guard brought in. This was across family, business, and business partnerships. Dr. Bina Modi prepared everybody to be future-ready.

All this Dr Modi achieved in a span of two years and counting.

The woods are still dark and deep and there are promises to keep.

I FIRMLY BELIEVE THAT MY DUTY AS THE CUSTODIAN OF THIS LEGACY IS NOT JUST TO PRESERVE IT BUT ENSURE PERPETUITY. TO NURTURE THE LEGACY, PROTECT IT, GROW IT AND ENSURE THAT THE FUTURE GENERATION TAKES IT FORWARD IS MY MORAL OBLIGATION. IT IS HARD, BUT I TAKE DEEP PRIDE IN IT," DR BINA MODI SHARES.

The flagship enterprise Godfrey Phillips India Ltd (GPI) got into shape. It channelized into a mean, agile and well-oiled machine that was now future-ready, with digital platforms. During pandemic the entire team got together as an extended "ONE GPI- family". It was a sweet and emotional achievement for her. She held discussions with team GPI in all regions and hand holding circles were made. "Together we shall move forward," she said to them. She also met all the business associates and assured them continuity and emotional support.

The other star company Indofil Industries, a specialty chemical company, too responded and made new blueprints in supple chain managements. The new guard came forward from the existing talent force. The company's international business also saw some new green shoots. The company reinvented itself.

Dr. Modi is confident of making the entire group a thoroughly professional entity, while also taking forward the legacy of K K Modi. She is determined to keep the family together and execute the last wishes of K K Modi, through the Trust Deed.

LESSONS IN RESILIENCE

At the root of Dr Modi's outlook of staying resilient even in the most challenging times is her abiding faith in her people and her inner resources. She recalls how her journey as a business woman started years ago when a good friend of hers, Evelyn Lauder of Estee Lauder, the world's leading cosmetic brand from New York, casually asked her: "Bina what have you done so far and what do you plan to do for the rest of your life? What is the legacy you are going to leave behind?" Lauder's question caught her up short. "My contribution as a daughter, sister, daughter-in-law, wife and a mother were undisputable, but as an individual, I realized I had not done any justice to my potential," she says. It was the catalyst that would change the course of her life.

Though she was excited about finding that new purpose in her life, which would be her legacy, it was easier said than done. After all, these were times when women were not always empowered to do any business.



Dr Modi at the inspection of GPI Plant, Ghaziabad with Mr Sharad Aggarwal, COO, Modi Enterprises